

XPreview+

User Manual

Version 1.0

A fast viewer for PDF documents, images, RTF and OpenDocument text,
with export of anything to PDF.

macOS · Windows · Linux

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https://github.com/swijeyes/XPreview-Plus

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1 Introduction

XPreview+ is a document and image viewer in the spirit of a built-in document viewer. It opens a file almost instantly, shows it page by page, lets you search, select and copy text, and can turn any file it opens into a PDF. It runs on macOS and Windows, and can be built for Linux.

1.1 What XPreview+ can open

- **PDF documents**, including password-protected ones.
- **Images**: PNG, JPEG, GIF, WebP, TIFF (including multi-page TIFF), BMP, SVG and more; HEIC on macOS. See Section 11 for the complete list.
- **Rich Text Format** (`.rtf`) documents, such as those from TextEdit, WordPad or Word.
- **OpenDocument Text** (`.odt`, `.ott`, `.fodt`) documents, such as those from LibreOffice, Google Docs or Microsoft Word.

1.2 Highlights

- **Page thumbnails** and a **table of contents** in the sidebar.
- **Export as PDF** for every file type.
- **Search** with highlighted results, **text selection** and **copy**.
- Smooth **zooming** (including trackpad pinch), **fit to width or page**, and **rotation**.
- **Tabs**, so several documents can be open in one window.
- **Private and safe**: XPreview+ never connects to the internet on its own, never runs macros or scripts, and treats every file as potentially hostile.

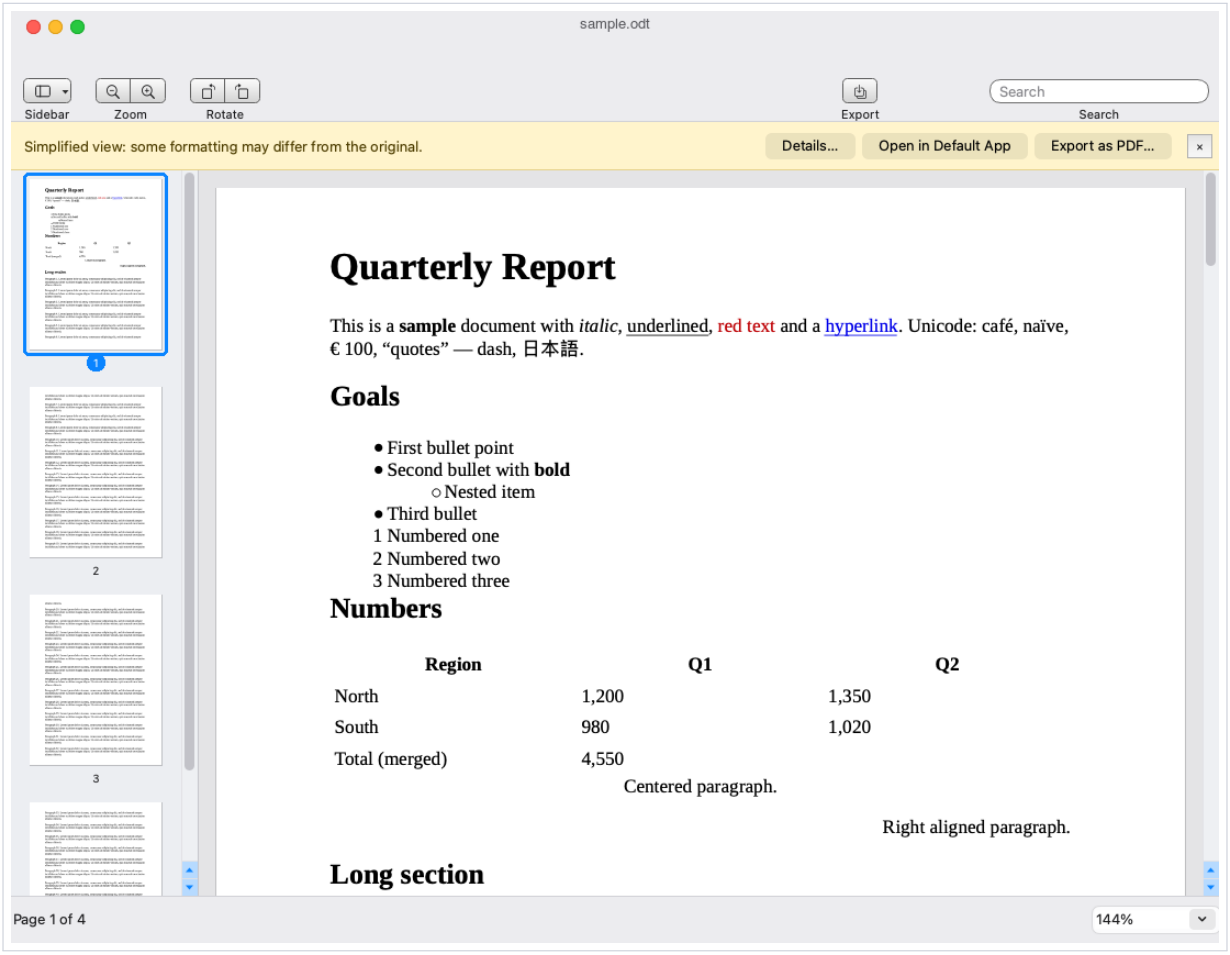


Figure 1: XPreview+ showing an OpenDocument text file, with page thumbnails in the sidebar.

2 Installing XPreview+

2.1 macOS

Requirements: a Mac with Apple silicon (M-series) and a recent version of macOS.

1. Download `XPreviewPlus-1.0-macos-arm64.dmg` from the project's Releases page.
2. Double-click the downloaded file to open it.
3. Drag the XPreview+ icon onto the Applications folder shown next to it.
4. Eject the disk image (drag it to the Trash, or click the eject button in Finder).

Opening it the first time

If the copy you downloaded is not notarised by Apple, macOS blocks it the first time you open it and shows a message that it "cannot verify" the app. To allow it:

1. Try to open XPreview+ once and close the warning.
2. Open **System Settings > Privacy & Security**.
3. Scroll down to the message about XPreview+ and click Open Anyway.
4. Confirm with your password or Touch ID.

You only need to do this once.

Removing XPreview+

Drag XPreview+ from Applications to the Trash. To also remove its settings, see Section 13.

2.2 Windows

Requirements: 64-bit Windows 10 or Windows 11.

XPreview+ for Windows is *portable*. There is no installer, and it never writes to the Windows registry.

1. Download `XPreviewPlus-1.0-windows-x64-portable.zip` from the Releases page.
2. Right-click the zip file, choose Extract All..., and pick a folder, for example your `Documents` folder or a USB stick.
3. Open the extracted `XPreview+` folder and double-click `XPreview+.exe`.

If Microsoft Defender SmartScreen shows "Windows protected your PC", click More info and then Run anyway. This appears for new applications that are not yet widely downloaded.

> **Note:** Keep all the files in the `XPreview+` folder together; the program needs them. Your settings are stored in a `settings` folder inside it. To remove XPreview+, delete the folder.

2.3 Linux

There is no ready-made Linux package yet. XPreview+ can be built from source; see the `README` in the project repository.

2.4 Checking your download (optional)

Each download on the Releases page has a matching `.sha256` file containing its checksum. To check a download, open a terminal in the folder where you saved both files and run `shasum -a 256 -c` followed by the name of the `.sha256` file (on Windows, `CertUtil -hashfile` *`file`* `SHA256`), and compare.

3 The XPreview+ window

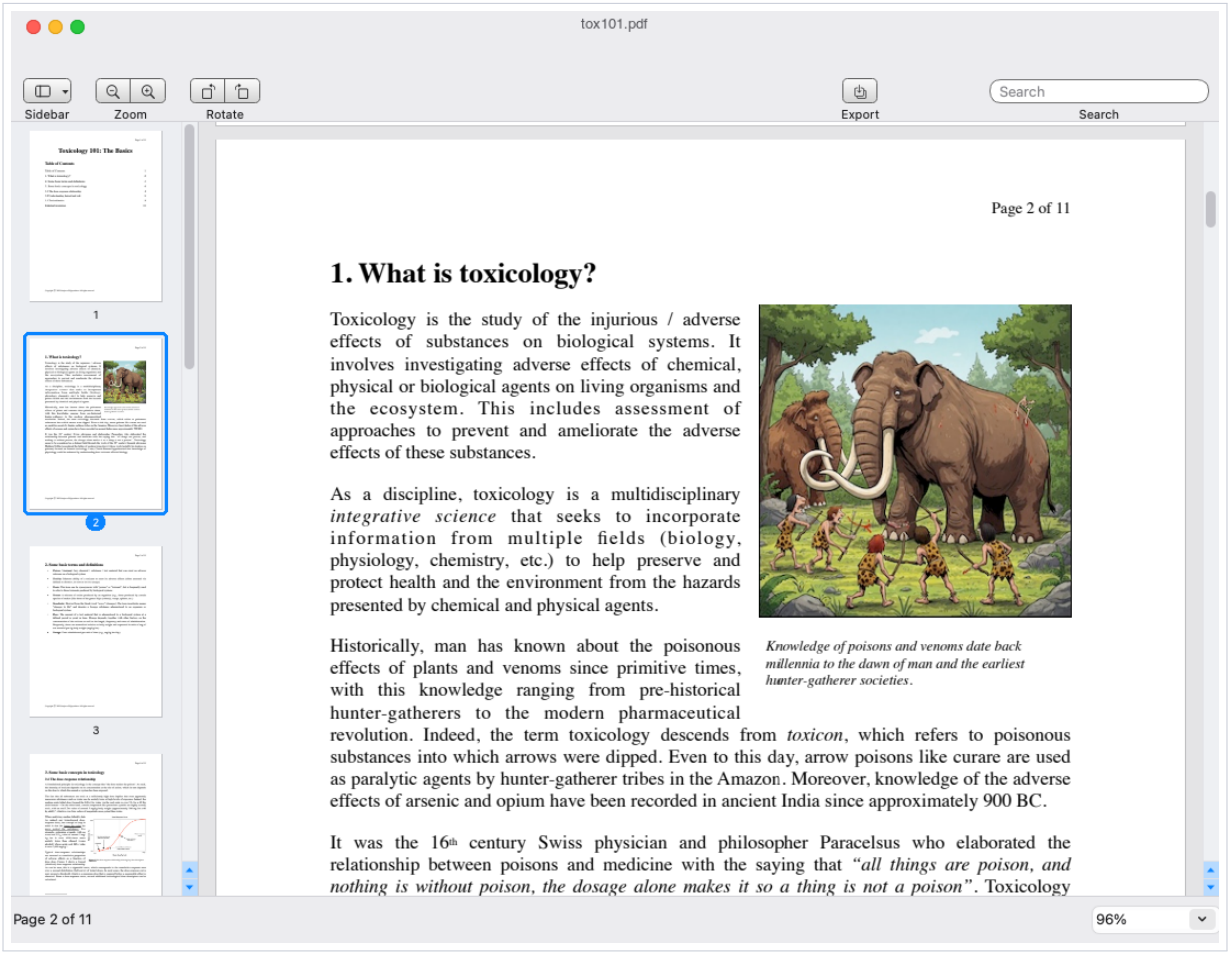


Figure 2: The main window with a PDF open. Thumbnails are on the left, the page view on the right, and the status bar along the bottom.

3.1 Toolbar

From left to right:

Sidebar button
: Click to show or hide the sidebar. Click the small arrow next to it to choose between Thumbnails and Table of Contents.

Zoom out / Zoom in
: Step the zoom down or up.

Rotate left / Rotate right
: Turn the pages a quarter turn.

Export as PDF
Save the current document as a PDF (Section 8).

Search field
Find text in the document (Section 6). The number of results appears to its left.

3.2 Sidebar

The sidebar shows either **page thumbnails** or the **table of contents**. Drag the thin divider between the sidebar and the page to make it wider or narrower; thumbnails grow and shrink with it.

3.3 Page view

The main area shows the pages of your document one after another on a grey background. Scroll to move through the document.

3.4 Status bar

The left side shows the current page, for example "Page 2 of 9". For single-page files it shows the file type instead. The right side has the **zoom box**. It shows the current zoom, and you can choose Fit Width, Fit Page or a percentage from it, or type a value such as `140%` and press Return.

3.5 Information bar

For RTF and ODT documents that XPreview+ had to simplify, a yellow bar appears above the page (Section 10). Click the × button on its right to dismiss it.

3.6 Tabs

Each file you open gets its own tab. The tab bar appears as soon as two or more files are open. Click a tab to switch, drag tabs to reorder them, and click a tab's close button (or press Cmd + W) to close it.

4 Opening files

There are several ways to open a file:

- Choose **File > Open…** (Cmd + O on macOS, Ctrl + O on Windows) and select one or more files.
- **Drag** files onto the XPreview+ window.
- On macOS, drag files onto the XPreview+ icon in the **Dock**.
- In Finder, right-click a file and choose **Open With > XPreview+**.
- Choose a recently opened file from **File > Open Recent**. The list keeps the last twelve files; Clear Menu empties it.

If a file is already open, XPreview+ switches to its tab instead of opening it twice.

> **Tip:** To have a type of file always open in XPreview+ on macOS, select such a file in Finder, choose **File > Get Info**, pick XPreview+ under Open with, and click Change All….

4.1 Password-protected PDFs

When a PDF is encrypted, XPreview+ asks for its password. If you cancel, the tab shows a message instead of the document; close it and open the file again to retry.

4.2 How XPreview+ recognises files

XPreview+ looks at a file's *contents*, not just its name, to decide what it is. If a file's extension is wrong (for example an RTF document named `report.pdf`), XPreview+ still opens it correctly and notes "detected as …" in the status bar.

4.3 Files that cannot be opened

If a file is damaged, of an unsupported type, or too large to open safely, its tab shows a short explanation. OpenDocument spreadsheets (`.ods`) and presentations (`.odp`) are recognised but not supported in this version.

5 Viewing and navigating

5.1 Moving through pages

- Scroll with the trackpad, mouse wheel or scroll bar.
- Click a **thumbnail** to jump to that page. The highlighted thumbnail follows the page you are reading.
- Click an entry in the **table of contents**.
- Use the **Go** menu: Previous Page, Next Page, First Page, Last Page and Go to Page….
- On the keyboard: Space and Shift + Space move a screen down or up; Page Up / Page Down and the arrow keys scroll; Home and End go to the first and last page. When the page fits the window's width, ← and → move to the previous and next page.

5.2 Table of contents

For PDFs, the table of contents comes from the document's bookmarks. For RTF and ODT documents, XPreview+ builds it from the headings. If a document has neither, the sidebar shows "No table of contents".

5.3 Zooming

- Use the zoom buttons in the toolbar, or **View > Zoom In** / **Zoom Out**.
- **View > Actual Size** shows the page at 100%.
- **View > Zoom to Fit** fits the whole page in the window; **View > Fit Width** fits the page width. Both keep fitting as you resize the window.
- On a trackpad, **pinch** to zoom. Double-tap with two fingers to switch between fit width and a closer view.
- Hold Cmd (macOS) or Ctrl (Windows) and scroll to zoom around the pointer.
- Use the zoom box in the status bar.

Zoom ranges from 5% to 3200%. Documents open fitted to the window's width. Images open fitted to the window, but are never enlarged beyond 100%.

5.4 Rotating

Tools > Rotate Left and **Rotate Right** (Cmd + L, Cmd + R) turn all pages. Rotation only affects how the document is shown; the original file is never changed. Exported PDFs and printouts use the rotation you see.

5.5 Viewing images



Figure 3: An SVG image. Images are a single page and are shown at their real size if they fit.

When an image is larger than the window, **drag** it to move it around. **Double-click** to switch between fitting the window and actual size. Multi-page TIFF files show one page per image. Animated GIF and WebP images show their first frame.

6 Searching

1. Click the search field in the toolbar, or press Cmd + F (Ctrl + F).
2. Type the text you are looking for and press Return.

Every match is highlighted in yellow and the current one in orange. The counter next to the field shows, for example, "3 of 12", or "Not found".

- Press Return again, or choose **Edit > Find Next**, to go to the next match.
- Shift + Return or **Edit > Find Previous** goes back.

- Searching ignores upper and lower case.
- Clear the field (click its ×) to remove the highlights.

Note: Images have no text to search. Scanned PDFs that contain only pictures of pages cannot be searched either, because XPreview+ does not perform text recognition (OCR).

7 Selecting and copying

7.1 Text

In PDF, RTF and ODT documents, drag across text to select it; the selection is shown in blue. Then choose **Edit > Copy** (Cmd + C) to copy it. A selection covers text on one page at a time. Click anywhere or press Esc to clear it.

Tip: To move around a zoomed-in document instead of selecting text, hold Option (Alt on Windows) while you drag.

7.2 Images

When an image is open and nothing is selected, **Edit > Copy** copies the image itself, ready to paste into another application.

7.3 Links

Click a link to follow it. Web and e-mail links (`http`, `https` and `mailto`) open in your browser or mail app. Links inside a PDF jump to the page they point to. The pointer turns into a hand over a link. For safety, other kinds of links are ignored, and nothing is ever opened without a click.

8 Exporting as PDF

Any file that XPreview+ can open can be saved as a PDF.

1. Choose **File > Export as PDF...** (Shift + Cmd + E), or click the export button in the toolbar.
2. Choose a name and location. XPreview+ suggests the original name with `.pdf`, in the same folder.
3. Click Save.

A progress window appears for longer documents, and the status bar confirms when the export is done.

8.1 What you get

PDF documents
: An exact copy of the original file. If you rotated the view, the copy is saved with that rotation.

RTF and ODT documents
: Real PDF pages with sharp, selectable and searchable text, the same layout you see in XPreview+, and the fonts embedded.

Images
A PDF page the size of the image, with the picture at full quality. SVG images stay sharp at any zoom.

Note: Exports are written safely: the new PDF only replaces an existing file once it has been written completely, so a failed or interrupted export never leaves a broken file behind.

9 Printing

Choose **File > Print…** (Cmd + P). In the print dialog you can pick a printer and the range of pages. Each page is scaled to fit the paper and centred, using the current rotation.

10 Document information and the “simplified view”

10.1 The Inspector

Tools > Show Inspector (Cmd + I) shows information about the open file: its type, the number of pages and details such as title, author and dates. For images it shows the dimensions and colour profile. It also lists anything that was shown in a simplified way.

10.2 Simplified view

RTF and ODT files are word-processor documents. XPreview+ contains its own renderer for them, so you do not need LibreOffice or Microsoft Word installed. It reproduces text, fonts, colours, lists, tables, images, headers and footers faithfully, but a few features are approximated. When that happens, a yellow bar says *“Simplified view: some formatting may differ from the original.”* Its buttons are:

Details…
Lists exactly what was simplified, for example “Footnotes are shown at the end of the document” or “Font substituted: Calibri → Carlito”.

Open in Default App
Opens the file in the application your computer normally uses for it.

Export as PDF…
Saves the document as you see it.

File > Open in Default App is also available for any file.

10.3 Fonts

Documents often use fonts that are not installed on your computer. XPreview+ includes free fonts with the same letter widths as the common Microsoft fonts, so lines and pages break in the same places as in the original:

Font in the document	Shown with
Arial, Helvetica	Arimo
Times New Roman, Times	Tinos
Courier New, Courier	Cousine
Calibri	Carlito
Cambria	Caladea

A font that is installed on your computer is always used as is.

11 Supported file types

Type	Extensions	Notes
PDF	`.pdf`	Full support, including password-protected files, bookmarks and links.
PNG, JPEG, BMP	`.png` `.jpg` `.jpeg` `.bmp`	Rotation stored in photos (EXIF) is applied automatically.
GIF, WebP	`.gif` `.webp`	Animated images show their first frame.
TIFF	`.tif` `.tiff`	Multi-page TIFF files show all pages.
SVG	`.svg` `.svgz`	Vector images; stay sharp at every zoom.
HEIC, JPEG 2000	`.heic` `.heif` `.jp2`	macOS only.
Other images	`.ico` `.icns` `.tga` `.wbmp`	
Rich Text Format	`.rtf`	Fonts, colours, lists, tables, pictures (PNG, JPEG), links, headers, footers, footnotes.
OpenDocument Text	`.odt` `.ott` `.fodt`	Styles, headings, lists, tables, images, links, headers, footers, page numbers, footnotes.
OpenDocument Spreadsheet / Presentation	`.ods` `.odp`	Recognised, but not supported yet.

11.1 Known limitations of the RTF and ODT renderer

- Multiple text columns are shown as a single column.
- Footnotes are collected at the end of the document rather than at the foot of each page.
- Text boxes and frames are placed in the flow of the text, near where they are anchored.
- Drawings made of shapes, embedded charts without a preview picture, and WMF/EMF pictures (common in older RTF files) appear as labelled placeholders.
- All pages use the page size of the document's first section.
- Comments are hidden. Documents with tracked changes show the final text.

12 Keyboard shortcuts

On macOS, Cmd is the Command key and Option is the Option (Alt) key.

Action	macOS	Windows / Linux
File		
Open	Cmd + O	Ctrl + O
Close tab	Cmd + W	Ctrl + W
Export as PDF	Shift + Cmd + E	Ctrl + Shift + E
Print	Cmd + P	Ctrl + P
Quit	Cmd + Q	Ctrl + Q on Linux; close the window on Windows
Edit		
Copy	Cmd + C	Ctrl + C
Find	Cmd + F	Ctrl + F
Find next	Cmd + G	F3 or Ctrl + G
Find previous	Shift + Cmd + G	Shift + F3 or Ctrl + Shift + G
View		
Hide sidebar	Option + Cmd + 1	Ctrl + Alt + 1
Thumbnails	Option + Cmd + 2	Ctrl + Alt + 2
Table of contents	Option + Cmd + 3	Ctrl + Alt + 3
Actual size	Cmd + 0	Ctrl + 0
Zoom in	Cmd + + or Cmd + =	Ctrl + +
Zoom out	Cmd + -	Ctrl + -
Zoom to fit	Cmd + 9	Ctrl + 9
Fit width	Cmd + 8	Ctrl + 8
Go		
Previous / next page	Option + Cmd + ↑ / ↓	Ctrl + Alt + ↑ / ↓
First / last page	Cmd + ↑ / Cmd + ↓	Ctrl + ↑ / Ctrl + ↓
Go to page	Option + Cmd + G	Ctrl + Alt + G
Tools		
Rotate left / right	Cmd + L / Cmd + R	Ctrl + L / Ctrl + R
Show Inspector	Cmd + I	Ctrl + I
In the page view		
Screen down / up	Space / Shift + Space	Space / Shift + Space
First / last page	Home / End	Home / End
Previous / next page (page fits width)	← / →	← / →
Clear selection	Esc	Esc

Action	macOS	Windows / Linux
Zoom around pointer	Cmd +scroll, or pinch	Ctrl +scroll
Move a zoomed document	Option +drag	Alt +drag

13 Settings and privacy

13.1 Preferences

Open XPreview+'s preferences with Cmd + , on macOS, or from **Edit > Preferences** on Windows and Linux. Changes take effect immediately. The window has three tabs:

General
: the window's look — a **Modern** flat theme in Light, Dark or Automatic (Light is the default), or a **Classic** glossy look in Blue or Gray; the scroll-bar style when using the Modern theme; and whether opening several files keeps them together in one window or gives each file its own window.

PDF
: what Actual Size (100%) shows — pages at their printed size, or one PDF point per screen pixel — whether to return to the page you were last reading, and the initial page layout.

Images
: what Actual Size (100%) shows for images — their printed size, using the resolution saved in the image, or one image pixel per screen pixel.

13.2 What XPreview+ remembers

Separately from the settings above, XPreview+ remembers:

- the list of recently opened files,
- the sidebar mode (hidden, thumbnails or table of contents),
- the window's size and position,
- the folder you last opened a file from.

These are stored in:

macOS
: `~/Library/Preferences/org.xpreview.XPreview.plist`

Windows (portable)
: `settings\XPreview\XPreview.ini` inside the `XPreview+` folder

Linux
: `~/.config/XPreview/XPreview.conf`

To reset XPreview+, quit it and delete that file. On macOS you can instead run `defaults delete org.xpreview.XPreview` in Terminal.

13.3 Privacy and safety

- XPreview+ never connects to the internet by itself. It contains no analytics, no update checks and no accounts.
- Documents cannot make XPreview+ load anything from the internet or from elsewhere on your computer. For example, pictures referenced by an SVG or ODT file but stored outside it are not loaded.
- Macros and scripts in documents are never run.
- Links only open when you click them, and only web and e-mail links.
- Every file is treated as potentially hostile. Damaged or deliberately malformed files are handled safely and size limits stop them from exhausting memory. Such a file shows an error message instead of crashing the application.
- Exporting never changes the original file.

14 Troubleshooting

macOS says XPreview+ cannot be opened or verified
Allow it once in **System Settings > Privacy & Security** (see Section 2.1).

Windows shows "Windows protected your PC"
Click More info, then Run anyway.

XPreview+ is missing from "Open With"
macOS adds XPreview+ to that list after it has been copied to Applications and opened once.

A document looks different from the original
For RTF and ODT files, click Details… in the yellow bar to see what was simplified. For an exact rendering, use Open in Default App.

Text cannot be found or selected
The document may be a scanned image without a text layer, or an image file.

"The file is too large to open"
XPreview+ limits very large or deeply nested files to stay safe and responsive. For example, images may be at most 30 000 pixels wide or high.

A spreadsheet or presentation does not open
OpenDocument spreadsheets and presentations are not supported in version 1.0.

HEIC photos do not open on Windows
HEIC and JPEG 2000 images are only supported on macOS.

Something else is wrong
Reset XPreview+ as described in Section 13. If the problem remains, please report it (below).

14.1 Reporting problems

Please report bugs and ask for features on the project's GitHub issues page. Include your operating system, the XPreview+ version (**Help > About XPreview+**), and, if possible, a file that shows the problem. Report **security** problems privately through the repository's Security tab instead.

15 License and credits

XPreview+ is Copyright © 2026 Sanjeeva Wijeyesakere.

XPreview+ is free software: you can redistribute it and/or modify it under the terms of the GNU Affero General Public License as published by the Free Software Foundation, either version 3 of the License, or (at your option) any later version. It is distributed in the hope that it will be useful, but **without any warranty**; without even the implied warranty of merchantability or fitness for a particular purpose. See the license for details. The full text is included with the application (`LICENSE`). The source code is available at https://github.com/swijeyes/XPreview-Plus.

XPreview+ is built with:

- **Qt** (LGPL-3.0), the application framework;
- **PDFium** (BSD-3-Clause / Apache-2.0), for PDF rendering;
- **miniz** (MIT), for reading OpenDocument packages;
- the **Arimo**, **Tinos** and **Cousine** fonts (Apache-2.0), and the **Carlito** and **Caladea** fonts (SIL Open Font License 1.1).

Their licenses are listed in `THIRD_PARTY_NOTICES.md` and included with the application. The XPreview+ icon was created by Sanjeeva Wijeyesakere with Google Gemini.